

TOP SMARTPHONE TIPS OF THE HOUR

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Nowadays, cellular devices are no longer meant for calling only. Technology has gone through a herculean revolution in the last few years and changed our lives in various ways. Among many innovations, the smartphone has gained massive traction among people, with a huge insurgence of this device among masses. It has turned out to be an essential element of our lives, as it helps us play games, watch videos, take photos, read the news, send text messages, bank, shop and other imperative activities. It is altering the conventional way we do things and how we get in touch with various people.

In this context, we present to you some important smartphone tips, which would make your smartphone usage more trouble-free, user-friendly and convenient.

Documents digitisation. Smartphone cameras now come with quality sensors, eliminating the role of scanners to upload documents to the cloud. Such apps as CamScanner, GoogleDrive and EverNote can perform this activity without difficulty.

Personal assistant. Smartphones can help identify songs and movies with the help of virtual assistants such as Siri, Cortana and Google Assistant.

Apps such as SoundHound and Shazam can help identify songs instantly.

Fingerprint security. We all use many apps on our cellphones, including financial ones for e-wallets, bank accounts and the stock market. Hence, we require strong security to protect ourselves from forgery and hacking. Most financial apps come with a top-notch biometric sensor and face-recognition option for unlocking. It is highly advisable to use this feature even if the apps are secured with a password, because it is not difficult for a hacker to crack a password.

Third-party apps like AppLock or Norton App Lock can also help here.

Voice-enabled Wi-Fi. With the help of artificial intelligence (AI)-based virtual assistants such as Siri, Google, Bixby and Cortana, you can switch the Wi-Fi on and off using voice commands.

Lock screen contact details. If you lose your phone and someone finds it, how will he or she contact you to return the phone to you? To make this possible, you can put your contact details on your lock screen.

Voice-typing. It is now possible to have entire sentences automatically typed on phones and computers just by speaking the words. Voice technology has made this possible by introducing AI-based virtual assistants.

To enable this feature on Android phones, go to Settings > Keyboard & Input Method and enable Google Voice Typing. Then, tap on the microphone icon on the keyboard and start speaking.

This technology has still not matured enough to capture all words. If your smartphone does not have this feature, you can install Google Keyboard to use it, which is available for both Android and iOS.

Also, this feature is being developed in many Indian languages, too.

Smartphone security. Some tips to keep your smartphone secure are:

Wireless protection. When a device's data passes through airwaves, it augments

the chances of hacking. To keep data safe, switch off your wireless connection when the phone is not in use—this also ensures that other people cannot connect to your device without your consent.

Also, make sure that the router in your home has a strong security key.

Check your phone's network security settings often because it might have automatically linked to a network in range without your knowledge.

Bluetooth protection. Compared to Wi-Fi, Bluetooth is not that risky because its range is quite small, of about ten metres. But if a hacker is close to your Bluetooth range, he or she might be able to access your phone data. Hence, always ensure that your Bluetooth is turned off when you are not using it.

Also, keep it Non Discoverable so that people around you cannot locate it. And, always ignore unknown requests for pairing.

Screen lock. Along with a fingerprint sensor, a secondary security feature is present in most phones. There is the option of using a pattern or numeric code that can help unlock your device if your fingerprint sensor is not working. In case of pattern lock, clean the display often because if your phone is stolen, it can be unlocked using fingerprint traces. Hence, a numeric code is a better option for enhanced security.

You also have the option of remote tracking on both iOS and Android, namely, Find my iPhone and Find my Device, respectively.

SIM card lock. SIM card lock is another major smartphone security option. Sometimes, even with a strong passcode on your phone, a hacker can use your SIM card on another phone. To avoid this, set up a SIM card lock in PIN format, which will be shown when your phone is turned on to connect to a network. **EFY**